

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 6 3  
 ♥ 7 6 2  
 ♦ K Q 10 5  
 ♣ J

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 9 6 4

♣ 9 2



♠ J 4

♥ K Q 9 5 4

♦ J 7 3

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 5

♥ J 10

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 8 7 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥5, West plays the ♥2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You are very lucky. Apparently East led from ♥ K Q so you won an undeserved ♥ trick. Now, if ♣s split 2-2 you can make 12 tricks! But hold it a minute. If you play dummy's two top ♣s and they **DON'T** split 2-2 you will only win two ♣ tricks and the contract will fail. Instead you should play a small ♣ from dummy right now. The defenders will win the trick easily, but you will win their return and you will still have a ♣ to get to dummy's 6 ♣ winners!

Ducking a ♣ is the only way to make the contract and you might as well do it at the second trick.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 6 4  
 ♥ 7 3 2  
 ♦ A 8 5 4 2  
 ♣ 6 5

♠ J 8 3

♥ J 10 8 5

♦ K J

♣ Q 9 8 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A K 5

♥ A K 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 4 2

♠ Q 10 7 2

♥ Q 9 4

♦ Q 10 9

♣ J 10 7

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

home-free since dummy's 3 ♦ s are now established.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠2, North plays the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners and dummy's ♦ suit is your only hope. **IF** ♦ s split 3-2 and **IF** the defenders don't take too many winners in their suit(s) you can establish ♦ s by ducking twice.

Win the first ♠. If you hold up they might pocket the ♠ trick and switch to another suit where you only have two stoppers.

Next play a small ♦ from each hand. Win the return (probably a ♠) and duck a second ♦.

If the defenders can only take 2 ♠ tricks now you are

You had to have the defender's ♠ s split 4-3. But in fact you were pretty sure they were going to do so. Since South's ♠2 was probably his fourth-down then he couldn't have a fifth-down.

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 5 2

♥ 7 4 2

♦ 8 7

♣ J 8 7 2

♠ A 7 4

♥ K 10 9 8 3

♦ J 5 3

♣ Q 3



♠ J 9 8

♥ A 6 5

♦ Q 10 9 6

♣ K 9 5

♠ K 6 3

♥ Q J

♦ A K 4 2

♣ A 10 6 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

North's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 5

Obviously you need to establish 4 ♥ winners and by driving out the ♥A you can manage that handily. The problem is that dummy has only one sure entry, (the ♠A), and the defenders may be good enough to hold up their ♥A twice.

To assure the contract you should win the first trick in your hand with the ♠K. Then play ♥Q, ♥J overtaking with dummy's ♥K so you can continue establishing the suit while you still have that ♠ entry.

None of the other suits were sitting well so overtaking the ♥ was the way to go.